

Rabbi Avi Bensoussan

848-525-0927 | Lakewood, NJ



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PROFILE

Ordained Rabbi and community leader with over 20 years of experience directing one of Lakewood's most impactful nonprofit organizations. Known for building unconditional relationships with at-risk youth and families, creating environments where people feel seen, accepted, and supported. Equally skilled as a speaker, mentor, fundraiser, and organizational leader.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Director

2004 – Present

Minyan Shelanu | Lakewood, NJ

- Leads day-to-day operations of one of New Jersey's premier at-risk youth organizations
- Built and sustained a non-judgmental, welcoming environment serving hundreds of teens and young adults annually
- Oversees programming, staffing, community outreach, and donor relations
- Developed and maintained relationships with rabbinical authorities, mental health professionals, and crisis counselors
- Recognized speaker on topics of youth at-risk, substance abuse, and community responsibility

Community Rabbi & Mentor

2000 – Present

Lakewood Jewish Community | Lakewood, NJ

- Provides pastoral counseling, halachic guidance, and crisis intervention to individuals and families
- Received Semicha in Issur v'Heter, Shabbat, and Niddah; Shimush in Marot from leading halachic authorities
- Trusted advisor to families navigating sensitive community and personal challenges
- Regular speaker at community events, schools, and organizations throughout the tri-state area

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

Leadership: Nonprofit management, organizational development, staff oversight, strategic planning

Community: Youth outreach, at-risk intervention, substance abuse awareness, family counseling

Speaking: Public address, community education, fundraising events, panel discussions

Pastoral: Halachic guidance, crisis support, mentorship, relationship building

EDUCATION & ORDINATION

Semicha — Issur v'Heter, Shabbat & Niddah

Under R' Z.N. Goldberg zt"l and R' Yitschok Berkowitz

Shimush in Marot — Advanced Halachic Training

REFERENCES

Available upon request.